

Interview Preparation Guide

Prepared for you by Kris Watson | kwwatson.com

Congratulations on your upcoming interview! Use this guide to prepare thoroughly, show genuine interest, and walk in with confidence. Work through each section before your interview day.

The 4 P's of Communication

How great communicators make ideas stick



Practice

- ✓ Use first names
- ✓ Smile
- ✓ Use Gestures



Presence

- ✓ Eliminate filler words
- ✓ Maintain eye contact
- ✓ Vary tone and volume



Pace

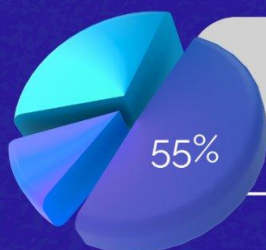
- ✓ Breathe intentionally
- ✓ Ask questions to reset attention



Pause

- ✓ Pause before key ideas
- ✓ Silence increases impact

Communication Impact



Visual

55%



Vocal

38%



Verbal

7%

People remember how you deliver more than what you say

Presentation setup



Camera at eye level



Look into the camera



Use natural Gestures



Good lighting and background

SECTION 1 — Company Research

Before anything else, research the company. The more you know, the more confident and credible you'll come across.

What to Research	Your Notes
Company Name	
Industry	
Business Model	<i>How do they make money?</i>
What they do	
Who they serve	<i>Target customers / end users</i>
Products / Services Offered	
Problem they solve	
Business size	<i>Headcount, revenue scale</i>
Funding status	<i>Public or private? Recent rounds?</i>
Startup runway	<i>If a startup - how soon will they turn a profit?</i>
Leadership team	<i>Who leads the company? Any notable backgrounds?</i>
HQ & employee locations	<i>Remote, hybrid, or in-office?</i>
Top 3 competitors	<i>How do they differentiate?</i>
Market position	<i>Were they first to market or a challenger brand?</i>
Market / analyst sentiment	<i>Gartner, Forrester, stock market, analyst reports</i>
Customer reviews	<i>G2, Capterra, company testimonial pages</i>
Employee reviews	<i>Glassdoor, LinkedIn, direct outreach</i>
Company exit plan	<i>IPO, acquisition, or staying private?</i>

SECTION 2 — Your Intention: Why Do You Want to Work Here?

Be specific. Generic answers like “I love the culture” fall flat. Find something real that resonates with you — from your research.

Reflection Question	Your Answer
Why do you want to work here?	<i>Write your honest answer</i>
What specifically about the problem they solve excites you?	
What about their leadership team stands out?	
Does their size / stage feel right for you?	
What did customer reviews tell you that matters to you?	
Does their culture / leadership style match how you work best?	

SECTION 3 — Who Will Be Interviewing You?

Research your interviewers before the call. It builds rapport, shows initiative, and helps you tailor your answers.

What to Look Up	Your Notes
Name & Title	
Career history	<i>What roles / companies led them here? Anything interesting?</i>
LinkedIn bio	<i>Any shared interests, experiences, or connections?</i>
Mutual connections	<i>Common contacts or thought leaders you both follow?</i>
Podcast appearances	<i>Have they been on a podcast? Listen to at least one episode.</i>
Social media activity	<i>What topics are they posting about?</i>
Their role & day-to-day	<i>Look up a JD for their title. What does their job look like?</i>
Team size	<i>How many people report to them? Who are your potential teammates?</i>

SECTION 4 — Your Elevator Pitch

You need a crisp, practiced summary of who you are and what brought you here. It should take 60–90 seconds. Rehearse it out loud.

What to cover:

- Where you started / your background
- Key experiences that shaped your career
- Why you’re here and interested in this role specifically

The 80/20 Rule for Job Descriptions

You don’t need to tick every box on the JD. If you meet ~80% of the requirements, you’re a strong candidate. Go through the description line by line and prepare a concrete example for each requirement you do meet.

JD Requirement	Your Example / Evidence

SECTION 5 — Common Interview Questions

Prepare honest, specific answers for each of these. Vague answers are forgettable. Stories stick.

Question	How to Answer
What sets you apart from other candidates?	<i>Highlight your top 3 strengths tied directly to this role. Use the JD to guide you. Back each one with a real example.</i>
What are your weaknesses?	<i>Be candid. Share something real you've struggled with, what you learned, and how you changed.</i>
What is your superpower?	<i>Stick to strengths that are directly relevant to this role — not general personality traits.</i>
Tell me about a time you made a mistake.	<i>Show how you handled it. What did you do to fix it, and what did you learn? This is about resilience and accountability.</i>
Tell me about a difficult problem you solved.	<i>Walk through your thought process. The interviewer wants to see how you approach challenges, not just the outcome.</i>
What have been your most significant accomplishments?	<i>Tie your achievements to the kind of value you'd bring in this role. Make the interviewer see what winning looks like with you on the team.</i>
Why do you want to leave your current role?	<i>Acknowledge what you've gained in your current role, then pivot to what genuinely excites you about this opportunity.</i>

SECTION 6 — Questions to Ask the Interviewer

Prepare 10–15 questions. An interview is a two-way conversation. You're evaluating them just as much as they're evaluating you. Questions that show curiosity and research will make a strong impression.

About the Role

Question	Notes
How do you define success for this role?	<i>Listen carefully — they're telling you exactly how to win.</i>
What are the top 3 goals you'd like this person to achieve in year one?	
What do you see as the biggest challenge for someone coming into this role?	
What personality traits tend to make someone successful here?	
What's the biggest strategic bet this team is making right now, and how does this role contribute to winning that bet?	
Tell me about the hardest unsolved problem within this organization.	

About the Team

Question	Notes
What is your management style?	
How often do you meet with your team?	
What does your best team member come prepared with?	
How does the team typically communicate?	
What's the dynamic like on the team right now?	
What's a decision this team made in the last six months that was genuinely hard, and what did that decision-making process look like?	

About Growth

Question	Notes
Is there a learning and development stipend?	
What does a typical career path look like from this role?	

Question	Notes
Are there examples of people who've grown into other roles from here?	

■ **Tip:** Save logistical questions (office schedule, remote policy, etc.) for the end once rapport and credibility are established.

You've got this. Good luck!

Questions? Reach out to Kris Watson at any time.